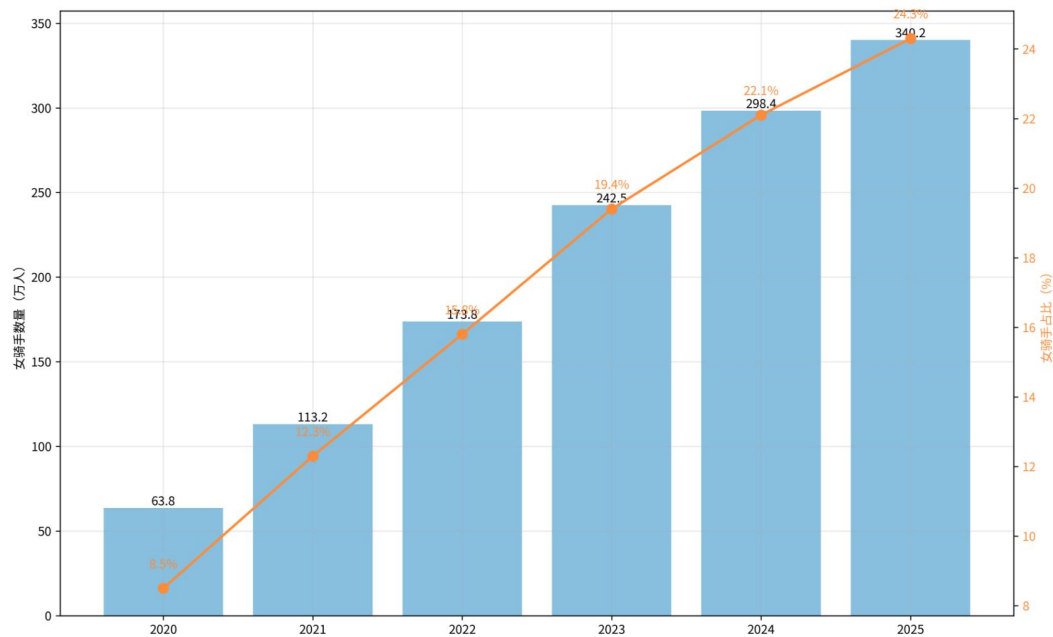




2020-2023 Meituan Female Food Delivery Riders Proportion

Female delivery riders for Meituan have shown the following development trends over the past five years:

Rapid Increase in Numbers: The number of female riders has grown from 637,500 in 2020 to 3.402 million in 2025, an increase of more than fourfold.

Consistent Rise in Proportion: The percentage of female riders among the total delivery workforce has risen from 8.5% in 2020 to 24.3% in 2025. This means nearly one in every four riders is female.

Accelerating Growth Rate: The growth rate of the female rider proportion has notably accelerated, especially after 2022. It increased from 15.8% in 2022 to 24.3% in 2025, marking a rise of 8.5 percentage points in just three years.

This trend reflects the increase in employment opportunities for women in the digital economy era and the growing appeal of **flexible employment models** for the female workforce.

Unlike male counterparts, many female riders must balance delivery work with caregiving responsibilities, yet the platform's incentive system heavily favors full-time riders with rigid schedules. Part-time women riders frequently earn less despite working similar or longer hours, simply because they cannot meet volume-based bonuses. I also found that safety concerns were more acute for women, especially late-night shifts, yet the platform provided no differentiated route recommendations or security measures. In response, I proposed algorithm adjustments that would recognize flexible working patterns and introduce safety features tailored to women's commuting needs.